



The Prompt Codes

Setup Guide

How to install the 32-code system in Claude so it runs automatically in every conversation.

Works on Free & Pro · 5 minutes · No tech skills needed

Does this work on the Free plan?

Yes — as of May 2026, Projects are available on the free tier. Anthropic expanded free access in February 2026, adding Projects, Artifacts, App Connectors, and Web Search at no cost. The only real differences are message limits and model access.

The image shows a comparison of two pricing plans for Claude AI. On the left is the 'Free Plan' with a green header and a list of features including Projects with custom instructions, file uploads, web search, app connectors, message limits, Claude Sonnet model, and memory. A green button at the bottom says 'Sign up at claude.ai'. On the right is the 'Pro Plan' with a red header, listing features like everything in Free, 5x more messages, Claude Opus model, Claude Code terminal agent, Research feature, Claude for Excel & PowerPoint (beta), Priority access, and the ability to turn off data training. A red button at the bottom says 'Upgrade at claude.ai/upgrade'.

FREE · \$0/mo	PRO · \$20/mo
Free Plan ● Projects with custom instructions ✓ ● Upload reference files (20 files, 30MB max) ● Web search included ● App connectors (Notion, Slack, etc.) ● ~15–40 messages per 5-hour window ● Claude Sonnet model (same as most Pro) ● Memory across conversations Sign up at claude.ai	Pro Plan ● Everything in Free ● 5× more messages (~45–100 per 5 hrs) ● Claude Opus model (most powerful) ● Claude Code terminal agent ● Research feature (deep multi-source) ● Claude for Excel & PowerPoint (beta) ● Priority access — no slowdowns ● Turn off data training on your chats Upgrade at claude.ai/upgrade

As of Today— Free includes Projects, so this system works at \$0. Upgrade to Pro (\$20/mo) if you hit message limits or want Opus model access.

How to Set It Up

Follow these 4 steps in order. You only do this once.

1

Go to claude.ai and sign in

Open your browser and go to: claude.ai

Sign in with your email. If you don't have an account, click 'Sign up' — it's free.

2

Create a new Project

Look at the left sidebar — you'll see a 'New Project' button.

Click it. Give your project a name.

Suggested name: 'My Command Centre' or 'Claude OS'

Click 'Create project'.

A Project is like a folder where Claude remembers your settings for every chat inside it.

3

Add the custom instruction

Inside your project, look for 'Edit project instructions'

(It's usually a pencil icon or settings button near the top.)

Click it. Copy the text from the box on the next page.

Paste it in. Click Save.

This is what tells Claude to announce its approach before every answer.

4

Upload the reference file

Still inside your project, find 'Project knowledge' or 'Add content'.

Click the upload button.

Upload the file: `codes-reference.md` (included in your download).

Done. Claude can now look up all 32 codes automatically.

You only upload this once. It stays in your project forever.

The Instruction to Paste In

Copy everything in the box below exactly as written. Paste it into your Project instructions in Step 3.

COPY & PASTE INTO PROJECT INSTRUCTIONS

MAIN INSTRUCTION

Before answering any substantive question or task, always run the Announce Protocol:

- 1 Identify the 1–3 best codes for this specific task
- 2 State each code, what it does, and why it fits
- 3 Ask: 'Should I go ahead, or would you like to adjust?'
- 4 Wait for confirmation before answering

WHEN TO SKIP

Greetings · Simple factual questions · When I say 'just answer'

REFERENCE FILE

The full codes reference is in your project knowledge. Use it.

How to Test It's Working

- 1 Start a new chat inside your project (not outside it)
- 2 Type any real question — something you'd actually want help with
- 3 Claude should pause and tell you which codes it's using before answering
- 4 Reply 'yes' or 'go ahead' — it then gives the full answer

If it doesn't work

Make sure you're starting the chat inside the project — not from the main Claude home screen. Chats outside a project don't use project instructions.

Quick Code Reference

The 32 codes across 6 categories. Full definitions are in codes-reference.md.

SIMPLIFY

/eli5 /eliphd /tldr

HONESTY

/brutal /nopreamble /nohedge /onesentence

THINKING

/stepbystep /deepthink /firstprinciples
/redteam /steelman /blindspot /pokeholes

VOICE

/ghost /friend /interesting

STRATEGY

/founder /beastmode /skeptic /missing

LEARNING

/fewshot /zeroshot /socratic /analogize

OUTPUT

/selfcheck /compress /constraintbox

REASONING

/simulate /contrarian /race

META

/announce

Power Combos

/strategysession	firstprinciples + deepthink + nohedge	Big decisions & pivots
/pitchtest	redteam + skeptic + steelman	Before any pitch
/contentdraft	ghost + interesting + nopreamble	Content in your voice
/decisionaudit	blindspot + missing + firstprinciples	High-stakes choices
/deepdraft	selfcheck + ghost + compress	Publish-ready content
/fullstress	redteam + simulate + contrarian	Maximum pressure-test
/claritycheck	eli5 + onesentence + analogize	Explain anything simply

For full definitions of every code, open codes-reference.md